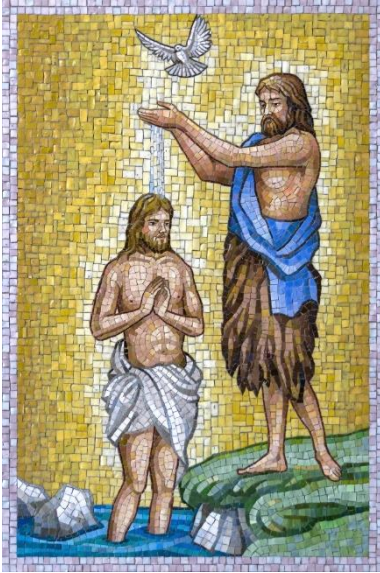


Living Savior Lutheran Church

September 2021 Newsletter

Pastor's Message



Shortly after I graduated from the seminary, an older, neighboring pastor was sharing with me his thoughts on ministry. We were driving from Philadelphia to Buffalo, New York for a conference, and we had a lot of time to talk. He was significantly older than I was, and had a great amount of experience in the life of the church. "To be a successful pastor," he said, "you must be able to pass the 'The John the Baptist Test.'" I was fresh out of the seminary and thought I knew everything — or thought I should know everything - so I nodded in agreement. Then he looked at me slyly, and asked: "You do know what the 'John the Baptist Test' is, don't you?"

With some embarrassment I had to admit — NO, I had no idea what "The John the Baptist Test" was. "Well, anyway," he continued, "John the Baptist had only one goal uppermost in his mind. Know what it was? It's simply this: John said, 'He must increase, but I must decrease'. That's John 3:30, in case you are wondering."

I was not wondering about the reference, but just what it meant. "That's the John the Baptist Test" all of us leaders must take and pass," he said. "To not care about any personal praise or criticism too much, but to do all we can to decrease ourselves in order to magnify Christ. We are just sign posts pointing not to ourselves but to him. That's the test that really matters." Those were the best words of advice I have ever received regarding ministry. We are not in the center, rather we are the "sign posts" pointing others to the cross of Jesus Christ.

In 1 Corinthians 4, the apostle Paul writes: "So then, men ought to regard us as servants of Christ and as those entrusted with the secret things of God. [2] Now it is required that those who have been given a trust must prove faithful." Paul is giving the Corinthians and us the "The John the Baptist Test"! He is reminding us that as we do our work in this congregation, we are servants of Christ, stewards who have been honored with tasks, but who, in the end, are still just servants. Our highest concern is that Christ might increase and we decrease, so that the church might increase in its life and work also magnify Christ.

I look forward to the exciting work we have planned together this year, as we seek to increase Christ!

God's peace this month,

Pastor Andrews C. Lissy

Living Savior Lutheran Church

September 2021 Newsletter

WORSHIP AND MUSIC

By Wally Horton



The Psalmist writes, "O sing to the LORD a new song, for He has done wonderful things." Ps. 96:1

Thanks be to God that Living Savior has been singing our songs of praise to Him throughout the past months. As we move into the Fall we have opportunities to sing "a new song to the LORD."

Both the Chancel Choir and Modern Worship Ensemble will commence rehearsals after a year

and a half hiatus due to pandemic precautions.

The Chancel Choir will hold their rehearsals on Wednesday nights from 7:30 until 8:45 beginning September 15. The Modern Worship Ensemble will hold their first rehearsal on Tuesday, September 21 also at 7:30.

Please contact Dr. Horton for information regarding the Chancel Choir and Candie Jefferson (canpiano4@yahoo.com) regarding information about the Modern Worship Ensemble. Both groups will observe safety precautions as we return to opening all of our ministries at LSLC.

Also, if you are an experienced instrumentalist and would be available to occasionally use your gift in worship, please contact Dr. Horton.

The Lay Readers Ministry is also seeking new candidates to serve as readers in our services. Please contact Dr. Horton for training and scheduling.

Living Savior Lutheran Church

September 2021 Newsletter

President & VP Message

By Steve Galing and Deb Malone

Labor Day weekend is historically the time we acknowledge the end of Summer and the beginning of fall. Living Savior Lutheran Church celebrated the end of Summer by holding a picnic on Saturday September 4th, the first since the onset of the coronavirus in the Winter of 2019. 61 parishioners and friends enjoyed a wonderful afternoon with hamburgers, hotdogs, potluck dishes, fellowship, and a variety of games.



While everyone had a good time at the picnic, we remember the important events from this past summer. First, LSLC said farewell to Vicar Tim and welcomed Vicar Scot and his wife Veronica. Secondly, we said farewell to Liz Smith, our Preschool Director and long-time staff member, and welcomed Terri Kiss as the new director. Due to Liz's ability to secure two grants, we were able to paint the preschool rooms, replace the lights, and install vinyl tiles. These improvements will greatly improve our ability to deliver a high quality, Christ-centered educational program. Thirdly, Boy Scout Troop 1346 and Venture Crew 1346 are beginning to transition to LSLC. Their first big event: a campout on 10-12 September. We are excited about the opportunities to reach out to the community as the chartering organization. Lastly, we prepare to start the Fall with a vibrant Sunday School program for all ages.

We thank the many members who volunteer their time and talents. Without you, LSLC would not be able to achieve it's mission to reach the unchurched in our community and bring others to Christ. We encourage everyone to step forward and volunteer...every task is important, and no task is too small.

May God continue to bless you and your family.

In His Service,

Deb Malone and Steve Galing

Vicar's Message

By Vicar Scot

Greetings in Christ to the community of saints here at Living Savior! It has been a joy and a blessing to be so warmly welcomed into your congregation. Veronica and I have been touched by the outpouring of friendship and generosity upon our arrival in Virginia. We are especially looking forward to getting to know as many of you as we can throughout the year. I am hopeful that my vicarage year will be a year of

Living Savior Lutheran Church

September 2021 Newsletter

learning and growth for me as I continue down the path of pastoral formation leading to full-time parish ministry. Throughout this year, I welcome your feedback and conversation and pray it will help me grow spiritually and emotionally as I prepare for the awesome responsibility of pastoral ministry. I am here to serve and learn and Living Savior has already provided me with many beneficial opportunities to do just that!

Part of my vicarage assignment is an outreach opportunity to students at George Mason University. This “campus ministry” aspect of my vicarage is something I am extremely excited about. Living Savior’s connection, Bridges International, has already begun setting up events for the coming academic year and I am thrilled to be collaborating with them. Apart from our weekly worship together, I am also looking forward to opportunities to teach bible class and grow with you all as we engage with God’s word and are fed by its richness and power.

I can already tell the time Veronica and I will spend here at Living Savior will be special and not just because of the addition to our family in February 2022 with the birth of our first child. I am excited to see how God works in and amongst you all as you live as the body of Christ in the world.

In Christ,

Vicar Scot

Bible Studies /Sunday School / Groups



Sunday School starts September 12. We welcome all school age children to a fun-filled time learning about Jesus. The unit this fall focuses on Jesus’ birth, growing up, and many of his miracles. Primary class is for PreK-Grade 1. Upper elementary is for Grades 2-5. We will meet between services from 10:00 to 10:45 in the Preschool wing. Please email [Jean-Marie Galing](mailto:Jean-Marie.Galing@living-savior.org) to register your children.



Starting Sunday, September 12, we will start a new Adult Sunday School series. We will return to the subject of the Trinity, and do a deep dive on this important doctrine of Christianity. Where is the Trinity in the Bible? Does the doctrine of the Trinity imply that there are really three gods and not just one God? Or is it that God plays several roles and switches between those roles? Is the doctrine of the Trinity something that was added later by certain councils and not part of the “original Christianity”? Join us as we deep dive the doctrine of the Trinity and learn how this doctrine is critical to a proper understanding of true Christianity. This interactive discussion should be appropriate both for those new to this doctrine and for those who are well-versed and want to dive more deeply into this doctrine. This new Adult Bible series will last six weeks and will be facilitated by Jason Tolbert in-person in Klein Hall at 9:50 AM.

Living Savior Lutheran Church

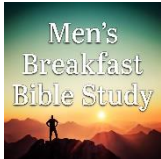
September 2021 Newsletter



Confirmation Class, Between Services Sundays (starting after Labor Day). Contact: Pastor Andy



Men's Christian Fellowship Dinner – 4th Thursday of the Month, at 5:30pm outdoors by grille



Living Savior Men's Fellowship Study, 8am – 9:30am, 2nd and 4th Saturdays. Contact Paul Gross for Zoom address

Men's Happy Hour By Zoom

Living Savior Men's Fellowship Happy Hour, 1st and 3rd Friday evenings. Contact Paul Gross for Zoom address

Events at LSLC



Women's Ministry - A Visual Faith Workshop – Saturday, September 18, 9:30 – 12:00! Curious about creatively engaging in God's Word? Come join us in Klein hall as we learn about a variety of techniques for Bible Journaling. Bring a sketchbook and/or a journaling Bible to work in. Bring your favorite art or scrapbooking supplies if you have them, but we will have many supplies available to use / share. Come explore gelato crayons, colored pencil techniques, fancy fonts, collage, stamping, etc. Enrich your prayer and devotional time with a creative response to God's Word. Email Visual Faith Coach [Jean-Marie Galing](#) so we can prep enough supplies for participants.

Living Savior Preschool - Fall festival is scheduled for October 16th 10am-12pm



Living Savior Lutheran Church

September 2021 Newsletter

Social Ministry

Living Savior invites you to stay engaged in its work to help our neighbors!

- A huge thank you to all who made the Back to School drive so successful. Shelter House and Concordia Lutheran in Triangle were so very grateful for your generosity. Ashli (see picture, Ashli is on the right) at Artemis House/DVash (NOVACO) was so excited to get the backpacks & water bottles for the children in those programs. You matched each child that they identified to an age/gender appropriate backpack & water bottle! Exciting! Thanks for all the work you guys put in to making this “happen”.



- LSLC is collecting \$50 gift cards to Home Depot, Lowes and Walmart in support of LSMC Eastern, Southern and Southeastern Districts and their **Relief Efforts in Louisiana, Tennessee, Pennsylvania, and New York.** Look for Collection baskets in the Narthex.



- LSLC is collecting donations to support the **Center of Hope Orphanage & School** in the aftermath of this year's hurricane and earthquake in Haiti. Please make checks payable to LSLC with Haiti Relief on the memo

LIRSCONNECT

• **Lutheran Immigration & Refugee Service** – Lutheran Immigration and Refugee Service is seeking volunteers to help refugees with airport transportation, house and meals. In addition, LIRS needs financial support to continue its assistance to Afghan families. Living Savior is organizing a team to help LIRS. If you would like to join us, contact <mailto:eakolton@gmail.com?subject=Refugees>. If you would like to make a monetary contribution, you can send / give it to LSLC (marked refugee support) or donate directly to LIRS. For more information see https://lirsconnect.org/get_involved/action_center/siv

Living Savior Lutheran Church

September 2021 Newsletter

- **Concordia Lutheran in Triangle, VA Needs Your Help!** Please help us in providing desperately needed food to more than 100 families per week. Drop off your food / pantry donations at the church or provide an on-line donation.
- **Moving in / Moving out Kits** – Please donate new home basics for those transitioning in/out of Domestic Violence Shelter House (collecting items quarterly). Drop off items at the LSLC. Contact Miki Kolton
- **Thanksgiving Dinner Drive** - Please donate Thanksgiving Dinner food items or gift cards for families at Domestic Violence Shelter House. Drive to begin early to mid-October. Contact Miki Kolton

Outreach Ministry

- **What's happening sheet** – If you want to see what is happening in July / August go to the LSLC website under Announcements to download the LSLC Outreach Information Sheet. Good to pass on to neighbors, family or friends who may be looking to get involved in the LSLC activities.
- **Greeters** – If you are interested in becoming a greeter at services please contact Ric Weyrick or Bob Willuweit

Youth Group Ministry – For more information contact Jonathan Loesch

- **Youth and Parents' National Youth Gathering Meeting**, Sunday, September 19th between Church Services
- **Youth DC Day Trip**, Saturday, October 16th, meet at Church at 9:00am
- **Fall festival / trunk or treat**, Saturday, October 30th, 2:00pm to 4:00pm in LSLC parking lot
- **Youth Group Meetings**, 4:00pm to 6:30pm at vicarage house, September 12th and October 3rd. Contact: Jonathan Loesch

Opportunities to serve

- **USHERS!!! We NEED USHERS** – Since many of the congregation are safe-at-home, we need those who can to help as Ushers. For Sunday 8:30 or 11am service Ushers, see Pastor Andy since he will be looking for volunteers for the upcoming months soon.

Living Savior Lutheran Church

September 2021 Newsletter



- **Altar Guild** – Please consider helping with altar guild duties. Teams are on a rotating schedule. Within each team, members decide how they will execute the month's responsibilities so that the schedule is convenient. Free training! Flexible schedule! Many hands make light work!
If you would like additional information, please contact Pam Belch:

pcbelch@comcast.net

- **Lay Crucifiers** –we have returned to using lay crucifiers at both in-person worship services. All lay people (men and women) middle-school age and older are welcome to serve as crucifiers. All must complete a short training prior to serving. To volunteer / schedule your training session, please contact Dr. Benson at mabenson2@gmail.com
- **Chancel Choir** – The Chancel Choir will resume rehearsals on Wednesday, September 15th at 7:30pm in the sanctuary. Membership is open to singers high school age or older. The ability to read music is helpful but not required. If you are interested in being a member of the Chancel Choir please contact [Dr. Horton](#).
- **Modern Worship Ensemble** – The Modern Worship Ensemble will resume rehearsals in September. If you are interested in participating, please contact Candie Jefferson or Dr. Horton for further information.
- **Lay Readers** – If you are a trained Lay Reader and would like to read in September or October, please see Dr. Horton to select a date(s) to read. If you have not received the training to be a Lay Reader but would like to become a Lay Reader, please see Dr. Horton so that you can receive the training. Please contact [Dr. Wally Horton](#).

Preschool

[Living Savior Lutheran Preschool](#)

Registration for 2021– 2022

Registration for the 2021-2022 school year is open. Please call the preschool office at 703-352-4208 or email at preschool@livingsaviorlutheran.org for more information or to schedule a tour. We offer programs for children ages 2 ½ to 5. Enrichment activities include Chapel, music, movement, in house presentations and field trips. This year has been a bit different with COVID restrictions, but we look forward to a return to normalcy just as soon as possible!

Please share this information with family, friends and neighbors who might be looking for a state licensed, nationally accredited Christian program for their children.

Living Savior Lutheran Church

September 2021 Newsletter

Opportunities to Worship

- **Sundays 8:30am**, Traditional Worship, Holy Communion 1st and 3rd Sundays
- **Sundays 11:00am**, Traditional Worship, Holy Communion 2nd and 4th Sundays, Modern Worship Services – selected Sundays (TBD)
- **On-Line Worship Opportunities**
 - **Sunday 11:00am service live-streamed and available for later viewing**, see LSLC Website for details <http://www.livingsaviorlutheran.org/>